

New Testament





About the Course

Students read through the book of Acts over the year. Additional study helps assigned in the lesson plans provide background information and context to help students begin to dive deeper into the life, ministry, and message of the early church.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grades 7-8



Placement & Combining Tips

Younger students in Grades 5-6 can be combined with older students if they have a good general understanding of the gospels. Ideal for HS students who are new to studying the Bible or unused to commentaries or discussions about cultural context or interpretive issues.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	New Testament: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition ESV Concise Study Bible Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grades 7-8				
Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grades 7-8	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9	Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

New Testament: Grades 7-8



The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition



ESV Concise Study Bible



Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

New Testament: Grades 7-8

- ∞ [Video overviews of Bible books from Bible Project](#)
- ∞ [Teaching the Bible with Dr. John Walton](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



New Testament: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

Read the commentary to prepare.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)



Introduce

Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

Read aloud from the Bible.



Narrate

Have the students narrate.



Share

Optional: Share something interesting from your preparation that will help shed light on the story.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Intro to Acts

- Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook
- Materials: Introducing the New Testament
- Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible

Note: Introducing the New Testament is a resource book that will be used over 5 years. As students get older, they will read more sections and interact with some of the more scholarly questions about the New Testament. Only small sections will be read this year, but feel free to read more.

→ INTRO

1. The book of Acts is actually "part two" of the Gospel of Luke, but it has been put in its own section in the New Testament (following the four Gospels) because it is the only book that relates the history of the early church—what happened after the events reported in the Gospels.
2. Watch this short video about Acts with the author of the book, Introducing the New Testament.
∞ Video Link: Acts

→ READ & NARRATE

1. p.205-206 "The book of" - "Lord Jesus Christ."
2. In the video, the author asked you to pay attention to the key motifs that are outlined in the book of Acts. A motif is a dominant idea or central theme. Read about a couple of the motifs or major themes in Acts:
p.216-220 "The book of" - "is worth remembering."
3. Although Luke is the author of two books in the New Testament, he is only mentioned three times in the Bible by name.
Read the following verses to meet the author of the book of Acts: Col. 4:14; 2 Timothy 4:11; Philemon 24; Luke 1:1-4; Acts 1:1-5; Luke 24:36-53

→ NOTEBOOK

You read about five of the major themes in Acts. Write down each theme on the top line of 5 different pages in your notebook. Then write a brief sentence of what that theme means. As you read through Acts this year, you will add the events that fall under the different themes.

WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

Ascension

- Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook
- Materials: Introducing the New Testament
- Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Acts 1:8 is the key verse of Acts, and the outline of Acts follows this verse as the gospel spreads and the church grows. Jesus gives the disciples a job after he leaves them on earth to ascend to heaven. "The ascension is the conclusion of the synoptic Gospels, and it is the introduction to Acts, where it begins the story of the development of the church" (Bible Story Handbook, Walton).



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→ READ & NARRATE

1. p.220-223 "The Jewish matrix" - "of his name."

Read about 3 more major themes in Acts. (You can skip Box 10.5.)

2. Acts 1:1-26

→ NOTEBOOK

Add the three additional themes you read about to your notebook and a brief sentence of explanation for each. Then record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant. There is not one right answer. For example, under the theme Centrality of Jerusalem, you can write: "Jesus orders his disciples not to leave Jerusalem."

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Pentecost

 Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Acts 2 is considered the church's birthday. Luke shows how the Holy Spirit came upon all the believers there, and how they began speaking in other languages. This may bring to your mind the story from Genesis of the Tower of Babel. However, "[a]t the Tower of Babel, nobody could understand the languages and it drove people apart. At Pentecost, the languages could be understood and it brought people together into a unity that helped start the Church" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 2:1-41

2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Study Bible.

- How does speaking different languages on the Day of Pentecost fit with the mission Jesus gave the disciples in Acts 1:8?

→ VIEW

Take a moment to look at the painting on p.211 (Fig.10.1 Pentecost). Describe what you see in the painting.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant. There is not one right answer. You may want to refer to Introducing the New Testament for extra guidance.

WEEK 4 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

Unity

 Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook
 Materials: Introducing the New Testament
 Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

The Holy Spirit came on the Day of Pentecost, and the Christians were united, which



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led to the expansion of the church in the early days.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. p.223-226 "As in the" - "to be offended."

Read about two more major themes in Acts. (Skip the boxes.)

2. Acts 2:42-47; Acts 3:1-10

3. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Add the two additional themes you read about to your notebook and a brief sentence of explanation. Then record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 5 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

Response to the Healing

 Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook

 Materials: Introducing the New Testament

 Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ READ & NARRATE

1. p.227-228 "The book of" - "like their master."

Read about one more major theme in Acts.

2. Acts 3:11-26

→ NOTEBOOK

Add the additional theme you read about to your notebook and a brief sentence of explanation. Then record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 6 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

Brought Before Leadership

 Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

The healing of the lame man brought the attention of the Jewish leadership to the disciples. The Sadducees mentioned in the passage were "wealthy and politically connected Jews who had control of the temple personnel but were not themselves priests. One of the distinctive elements of their doctrine was the rejection of the resurrection" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 4

2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- The word "bold" or "boldness" is repeated in Acts 4. Why was boldness needed on the part of the disciples?



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→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant. You may want to refer to Introducing the New Testament for guidance.

WEEK 7 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

Ananias and Sapphira

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 4:32-37; Acts 5:1-42
2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- How did the offering of Barnabas compare with the offering of Ananias and Sapphira?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 8 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

Stephen is Introduced

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In the book of Acts, Luke periodically gives a "progress report" of the early church. In verse 7, he gives a report that is glowing! But with all these additional people come additional responsibilities that must be taken care of. Chapter 6 will show the movement into the second part of the mission Jesus gave the disciples in Acts 1:8, before he ascended into heaven: that of the gospel moving out from Jerusalem to "all Judea and Samaria."

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 6
2. (Optional) Read the notes on chapter 6 in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 9 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Stephen's Sermon

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Stephen is charged with blasphemy for speaking "against the law and the temple, both of which had attained a sacred status in Judaism. To speak disrespectfully about them



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was considered criminal. To suggest that the temple and the law were inadequate or would pass away was heresy. It was taken as strongly as someone today undermining democracy, freedom, or human rights...Stephen's speech showed his respect for...the law, the Tabernacle, and the temple...It was important for Luke to show that Stephen was executed based on false (unsubstantiated) accusations and his association with Jesus" (Bible Story Handbook). While the reports of the church's growth are tremendously encouraging, the story of Stephen's martyrdom showed the persecution the Christians faced and the anger with which the leadership viewed these new believers.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 7
2. (Optional) Read the notes of the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 10 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10

Saul, Philip, Simon, & The Ethiopian Eunuch

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Through the end of Acts 7, Luke has described the preaching of the gospel in Jerusalem. It had been effective. Thousands had believed. In fact, others had flocked into the city to be with the apostles and had experienced the healings that were taking place. Now, beginning with chapter 8, the gospel expands to Samaria, and Philip becomes the instrument of the first great missionary outreach (James M. Boice, Acts: An Expository Commentary).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 8
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 11 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

Saul's Conversion

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Saul is brought back into the picture in chapter 9, with the story of his conversion. To the Jewish leaders, "the claim that Jesus is God was a major heresy and a threat to Judaism and had to be eliminated" (Bible Story Handbook). This is exactly what Saul's mission is at the opening of chapter 9. He wanted to persecute and eliminate the people of "The Way." Christians are called this a few times in the New Testament. Do you have an idea why? (Hint: John 14:6)

→ READ & NARRATE

• EXTRA HELPING

This interesting article tells how He Qi became a Christian and an artist during a turbulent time in China.

∞ **Article Link:** Article about artist He Qi



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1. Acts 9:1-30
2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- What does Saul's testimony teach us about the character of God and who God is?

→ VIEW

Take a moment to look at the painting on p.218 (Fig.10. The Call of Paul). Describe what you see in the painting. He Qi is a contemporary Christian artist who is influenced by Chinese traditional folk art.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 12 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Acts



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WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

Peter and Cornelius

Materials: ESV Concise Study, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

The end of chapter 9 and chapter 10 focus on Peter. Peter continues to minister, heal, and preach the gospel. In 9:31, Luke gives another progress report on the church. How does he define the early church's health and growth? In chapter 10, the story of Cornelius is a "key turning point in the book as the church is officially opened up to Gentiles" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 9:31-43; Acts 10
2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ VIEW

Take a moment to look at the painting on p.217 (Fig.10.2 A heavenly revelation). Describe what you see in the painting.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

Peter Tells of His Vision

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

News that Gentiles had also received the word of God and the Holy Spirit spread fast from Caesarea to Jerusalem. It is important to recognize that Jews familiar with their own Scriptures were not put off with the fact that the gospel was proclaimed to the Gentiles or that they shared in the promises of God...The issue that the "circumcised" believers had with Peter's encounter with the "uncircumcised" is not that they received the word of God from Peter, but the circumstances of the reception. The concern they had was that Peter went into a Gentile home and ate with them; the issue is one of purity. Of course, this was the identical problem Peter had himself before going to Cornelius's home (Dean Pinter, The Story of God Bible Commentary). The "circumcised" (a sign of the covenant) refers to the Jews, and the "uncircumcised" refers to the Gentiles.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 11
2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.



Term 2

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

Peter Freed from Prison

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In this passage, King Herod is the grandson of Herod who ruled at the time of Jesus' birth. He was new to the throne, so "it is easy to see why this ruler...was interested in gaining favor with the ruling Jewish council" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 12
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 4 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

Paul Begins His First Missionary Journey

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the NT, Notebook
Materials: Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

This week in Spiritual Formation, you will begin an in-depth study of chapter 17 of Acts, which will accompany your reading in Transformed by Truth. As we continue to read Acts, we will gain a larger context for the book and the early church's growth, which helps when studying a specific verse or even a single word.

The focus switches from Peter to the Apostle Paul. It continues to follow the pattern of the key verse, Acts 1:8, as Paul and Barnabas begin a missionary journey that would take them approximately 1,400 miles between AD 46-48 (Bible Story Handbook). Having seen Barnabas' name a few times already in Acts, why do you think he would be a good choice as a missionary?

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 13 (You may want to read and narrate shorter sections.)
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ VIEW

Look at map 10.1 on p.206. Trace the route of Paul's first missionary journey. Where did most of his travels take place?

→ NOTEBOOK

Pick one of the locations Paul went to and write a short description of the events that took place there.



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WEEK 5 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Paul and Barnabas Continue to Preach

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Paul and Barnabas continue on their first missionary journey. What is the gospel message they are preaching? Why do you think the gospel message brings opposition?

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 14 (You may want to read and narrate shorter sections.)
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- Discuss what 14:22b meant to Paul and Barnabas and what it might mean for you: "Through many tribulations we must enter the kingdom of God."

WEEK 6 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18

Jerusalem Council

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"After Peter declared the universal lordship of Jesus to Cornelius and his household, Luke describes how the early church in Antioch got on with this mission to "the world" by sending out Paul and Barnabas. By all accounts, this first mission journey to the Gentile world was a success. Yet its very success brought the early church to a crossroads. Today, you will read about the Jerusalem Council, which was a crucial moment in the story of the early church. The stakes were high. The decision the early church would make here would shape who they would be (identity) and how they would be together (unity). In this council, the leadership of the early church would deal with the question: What is to be the basis of the inclusion of Gentiles in the newly constituted people of God?" (The Story of the Bible Commentary).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 15
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 7 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19

Conversion of Lydia

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the NT, Notebook
Materials: Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In Acts 15:36, Paul's second missionary journey begins with Silas, Timothy, and Luke



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joining him. This second journey would take them approximately 2,800 miles between AD 49-52, with much of their time spent in the city of Corinth (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 16
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ VIEW

Look at map 10.2 on p.207. Trace the route of Paul's second missionary journey. How is this one different from the first?

→ NOTEBOOK

Pick one of the locations Paul went to and write a short description of the events that took place there.

WEEK 8 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20

Paul Speaks to the Areopagus

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In the context of the entire book of Acts, we have reached chapter 17, the chapter you're studying closely in your Transformed by Truth reading. While you are already familiar with what takes place in this chapter because of your study, reread it in the context of the book of Acts and in the context of Paul's second missionary journey.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 17
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

WEEK 9 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

Aquila and Priscilla

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the NT, Notebook

Materials: Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Paul continues to be helped in his ministry by acquaintances he meets. In Acts 18, Aquila and Priscilla help encourage Paul and minister alongside him, and later in the chapter, they kindly teach Apollos. The flow of the book of Acts shows the growth of the early church and shows how these individuals (people like Lydia, Aquila, Priscilla, Luke, etc.) were used by God to help build the church. Interestingly, Gallio mentioned here is the brother of Seneca, a (still to this day) famous Stoic philosopher. (Remember Paul's message in chapter 17 specifically included Stoicism when he preached against the Greeks and their philosophy.) Paul's third missionary journey begins in Acts 18:22 (some lists may say verse 23).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 18
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- What does the involvement of individuals of all backgrounds in the church's growth tell us about God and his character and who he is?



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→ VIEW

Look at map 10.3 on p.208. Trace the route of Paul's third missionary journey. Is the route more similar to the first or the second journey?

→ NOTEBOOK

Pick one of the locations Paul went to and write a short description of the events that took place there.

WEEK 10 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22

Paul Against the Goddess Diana

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Paul's third missionary journey begins in chapter 18, covering approximately 2,700 miles from 53-57 AD. More than half of his time would be spent in Ephesus.

→ VIEW

Look at figure 10.4 Ephesus on p. 220. Ephesus was the third largest city at that time and home of one of the seven wonders of the ancient world—the temple of Artemis (Diana), the goddess of the hunt.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 19
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

WEEK 11 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23

Catch Up

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 12 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Acts



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WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

Eutychus Falls Asleep

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In Acts 20, the story of Eutychus stands out as an interesting story of Paul healing a young man who fell out of a window...while listening to Paul speak! The presence of many lamps was not usual, but it gave the idea that the meeting had been planned to go into the night. "Possibly the heat or even odor from the lamps contributed to Eutychus seeking a window seat. Glass was rare in windows. Some windows could be large, especially above the ground floor" (Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 20
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- What are your thoughts about Paul's final message to the Ephesian elders? What does the emotional reaction on both sides tell you about their relationship?

→ NOTEBOOK

Pick one of the locations Paul went to and write a short description of the events that took place there.

WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

Paul Goes to Jerusalem

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

The missionary journeys are completed, Paul is going to Jerusalem for the last time, and arrives there in this chapter. He is arrested and so far as we know never again finds freedom.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 21:1-36
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- How does this passage show the progress of the spread of the early church in obedience to Acts 1:8?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.



Term 3

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

Paul Speaks to the People

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"Paul recounted his Jewish background and training as a Pharisee, his zeal in persecuting Christians, and his experience on the road to Damascus. He did not refer explicitly to his status as a Christian, for that was not a choice against his Jewish identity. The crowd was enraged when he told them of his call to preach to the Gentiles, for a Jew to recognize Jesus as the Messiah was not as objectionable as a Jew who reduced or eliminated boundaries between Jew and Gentile. The next day in the Sanhedrin, neither the identity of Jesus nor the mission to the Gentiles caused problems; it was the question of the resurrection" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 21:37-40; Acts 22
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 4 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

Paul Before the Council

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Do you think of circumstances as being things that are against you—something that God cannot control? Have you ever found yourself thinking, "If the circumstances of my life were different, perhaps then I could have been somebody or could have done something great for God or could have triumphed in the particular difficulty in which I am now"? Do not think that way. Circumstances do not limit God. Circumstances are not independent of God. God creates circumstances. God is the master of circumstances (Acts: An Expository Commentary). In this chapter, we will see how God uses an interesting circumstance to save Paul from being murdered.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 23
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.



Term 3

WEEK 5 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

Paul Before Felix

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"In this portion of the trial, Paul was accused of being a troublemaker who stirred up riots as a leader of the Christians. His opponents added the charge of desecrating the temple. Paul denied the charges, but did identify himself as a Jew and follower of the Way" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 24
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- Why do you think Felix brings his wife to visit Paul and listen to him talk about the gospel?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 6 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

Paul Before Agrippa

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"Festus succeeded Felix and heard the same charges that his predecessor had heard two years earlier. Paul knew that Festus was currying favor with the Jews and that he might be inclined to turn Paul over to them, which would have been catastrophic. As a Roman citizen, Paul had a right to appeal to Caesar, and he did so" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 25
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- What do you think about Festus' response of not having anything by which to charge Paul?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.



Term 3

WEEK 7 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

Paul Defends Himself to Agrippa

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"Nothing [in Paul's testimony] indicates that he was making proselytes to Judaism, thus indicating that this message had nothing to do with Jewish law. Agrippa was astonished at the claim when he referenced Christ and his resurrection. Despite that, he was persuaded that the charges against Paul by the Jews were unfounded. This finding is very important to the case Luke has been making throughout the book" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

- Acts 26
- (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- What do you think Luke's purpose is in presenting these different trials where Paul is put on the defense of himself?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 8 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Shipwreck

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

After all the trials he has been through, Paul is on his way to Rome. Unfortunately, he faces a different kind of difficulty this time. However, through it all, "God preserved Paul because he still had work for him to do" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

- Acts 27
- (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 9 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

Paul in Rome

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"God is at work getting his servant, Paul, to Rome where he will share the good news



Term 3

of Jesus" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 28
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- How has the gospel message gone into the world over the events of the book of Acts?

WEEK 10 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

Review

Materials: Introducing the NT, Notebook

→ READ

1. Read Overview of Acts and recall everything you read about this year. p.206-209
2. Read Box 10.7 Church of Joy p. 226. What does it mean to have joy, and why is that an important characteristic for Christians?
3. Read Conclusion p.228.

→ NOTEBOOK

Look at the different themes in your notebook. Which theme(s) has the most events associated with it?

→ VIEW

Watch this video about the last chapters of the book of Acts.

∞ Video Link: Bound for Rome: Acts 21-28

- How did the gospel reach you and your family? How are you continuing to spread it to others?

WEEK 11 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

Catch Up

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

EXTRA HELPINGS

You may be interested in watching this movie on the Book of Acts. They use the exact words of the Bible.

∞ Video Link: Movie on the Book of Acts

WEEK 12 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Acts

New Testament: Grades 7-8

Examination

Term 1

- Tell the story of the early church and how it grew.
- Tell about Peter and a few of the experiences that happened to him as he helped start the early church.

Term 2

- Tell about Paul's first missionary journey.
- Name three people who helped support Paul in his ministry in your reading this term.

Term 3

- What do you remember about Paul's third missionary journey?
- What are some hardships Paul faced on his journeys? How did Paul respond to these trials?